



Lab: Product Development Analysis

Estimated Duration: 45 minutes

In this lab, you will analyze the effectiveness of the product development efforts using a product development and release checklist.

Objectives

- Review a product development scenario
- Analyse the effectiveness of the product development efforts using a product development and release checklist

Prerequisites

1. You must have Microsoft Excel installed on your computer or a Microsoft Office 365 account online.
2. Ensure you reviewed the following videos:
 - Video: Product Development
 - Video: Product Requirements Refinement and Verification

Product Development Scenario

Stay Cool LLC (SC) is a moderately sized firm that operates out of Miami, Florida. They specialize in creating tailored Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning (HVAC) systems for mobile vehicles. One of their largest customers are the armed forces.

SC recently won a large contract to replace faulty HVAC systems in a large fleet of armored vehicles. The vehicle fleet was deployed to a desert environment, and the currently installed HVAC systems were found to be inadequate.

The Product Manager's name is Anita Mansfield. Anita led the way through the Conceive and Plan phases of the Product Management Lifecycle, and a Preliminary Product Management Plan was developed and approved. The project

is currently in the Develop phase. The product team just completed the Product Development sub-phase of the Develop phase and held a retrospective.

The team was appreciative of Anita's organized planning. She analyzed the project plan, determined that this HVAC development project was best suited to a predictive approach, and assigned Sam Howell as the Project Manager to drive product development efforts. Anita and Sam worked to ensure key stakeholders were identified and completed a comprehensive RACI that they shared with the team and validated.

The team was delayed based on their perception that the "good enough scenario" in the Preliminary Product Management Plan was the final and locked version driving the product development. Some details had to be added that were missing, and some requirements lacked the clarity required to implement the HVAC systems as required. These issues had to be addressed as development was occurring.

Operations and manufacturing were satisfied. They felt that hand-offs were well planned and the release plan was sound. Anita used a release planning checklist that had proven to be more than sufficient in the past.

The team did state that prototypes and mock-ups were developed that satisfied the need to share proposed HVAC mobile systems with the army and gain feedback. However, there were a few versions of the prototype, and on one occasion, the team shared the wrong prototype version with the customer. In addition, a few changes were made where half the team was aware of the change, and the other half were unaware. The team was also surprised when they realized they were unaware of a military compliance issue that impacted the HVAC design and packaging. The original packaging design was not sufficient due to military requirements.

Overall, the product development followed standard processes and yielded satisfactory results. The team will document the issues that occurred and strive to improve their effectiveness in future product development phases.

Exercise

Step 1: Keeping the CTRL key pressed, click [here](#) to download the MS Excel file titled **Product Development and Release Checklist**.

Note: Use the COMMAND key instead of CTRL on Mac systems.

Step 2: Use the Develop Phase Activity Checklist to determine what was accomplished well in the scenario and what problems were encountered. Strive to identify at least five issues.

Step 3: Go to the **Issues Log** on **Tab 2** of the Checklist. Document the five issues and develop a solution to address them in future product development projects.

Step 4: Save this file. This file can become part of a growing personal portfolio you can build to share new skills, tools, and techniques you learn in this course with peers, your team leadership, or external associates. A personal portfolio highlights your skills to those in your current organization or future organizations where you may seek employment.